

How to sell your used cars faster

Five factors that make the difference, and what to do about each one.

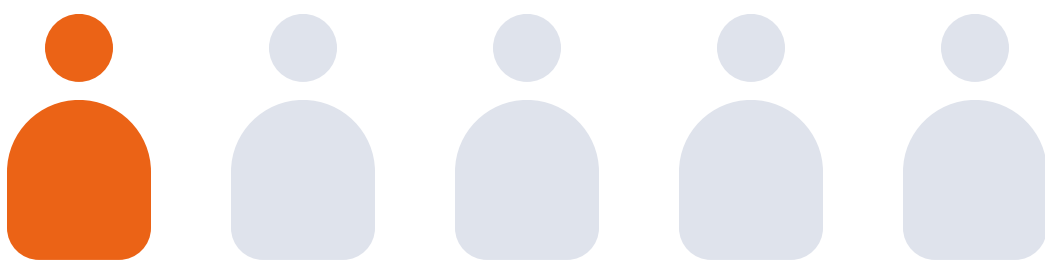
START HERE

A buyer used to visit five dealerships. Now they visit one.

TEN YEARS AGO



TODAY



Dealerships a buyer walks into before deciding.

The other four visits didn't disappear. They happen on **a screen**.

Comparing, shortlisting, ruling out: it all happens before a buyer contacts anyone. So the work of selling a car has moved as well. It now happens in your listing, before the phone ever rings.

**Five things decide whether your listing survives that.
The next pages take them one at a time.**

The five factors

01	Price	How your price compares to the same make, model, year and mileage near you. A buyer never sees your price on its own. They see it next to everyone else's.
02	Preparation	Cleaning, small repairs, everything you do to the car before it ever goes online.
03	Where you advertise	Which platforms the car is listed on, and how many of the right buyers actually reach it.
04	What the listing says	Damage, service history, previous owners. Written down in the listing, or waited for until someone asks.
05	What the listing shows	The photos, and what a buyer decides from them in the first few seconds.

The first two happen before the car ever goes online.

FACTOR 01

Price

Nobody sees your price on its own. They see it in a sorted list, under the same car from three other dealers. A few hundred too high doesn't cost you a negotiation. It costs you the click.

IN PRACTICE

Price against what is listed near you this week, not against what the car owed you.

Dealer A	12,450
Dealer B	12,690
Dealer C	12,880
MOST BUYERS STOP HERE	
Dealer D	13,050
Your car	13,200

Same model, same year, same mileage, sorted by price.

FACTOR 02

Preparation

A deep clean inside and out, clean wheels, a tidy interior. Everything you do to the car before it goes online is what a buyer will see, and none of it can be added afterwards. The car in the photos is the only car they will ever judge.

IN PRACTICE

Finish the cleaning and the small repairs before the car is photographed, not before the first viewing.



Prepare

Clean it, tidy it, put the small things right.



Photograph

Whatever is there now is what gets recorded.



List

Every buyer judges the car from here on.

Anything you skip in step one, you skip for the whole life of the listing.

Both of these are settled before anyone can see the car. The next two decide who sees it, and what they are told.

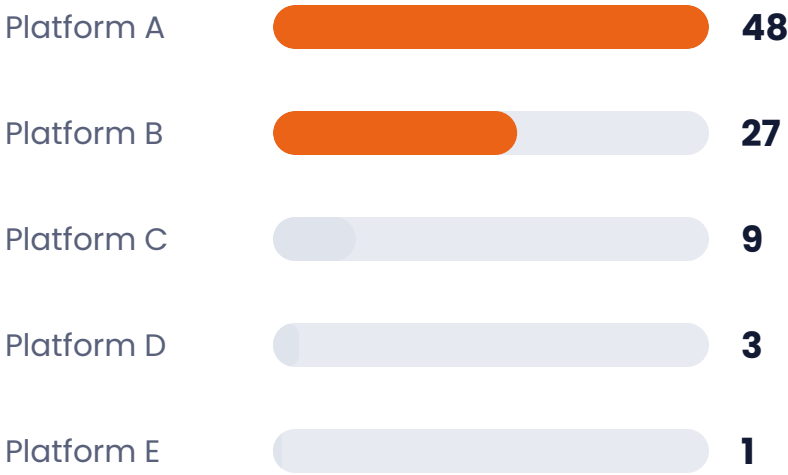
FACTOR 03

Where you advertise

Plenty of buyers only ever look in one place, and a car that isn't there doesn't exist for them. But listing everywhere costs money and splits your attention. Be where your buyers already are.

IN PRACTICE

Track where every enquiry comes from for one month, then spend accordingly.



Example: one month of enquiries at a single site. Three of these five are costing more than they return.

FACTOR 04

What the listing says

Damage, service history, previous owners. A buyer finds all of it out eventually. The only question is whether they find it out from you, or from the gaps in your listing.

IN PRACTICE

Put the three questions you always get on the phone into the listing.

WHAT A BUYER WANTS TO KNOW

- ✓ Any damage or paintwork
- ✓ Full service history
- ✓ Number of previous owners
- ? Outstanding finance
- ? Why it is priced where it is

Every question left grey is a phone call you have to take, or a buyer who moves on instead of asking.

**Priced right, prepared, in the right place, honestly described.
One factor left, and it is the only one a buyer meets before deciding.**

What the listing shows

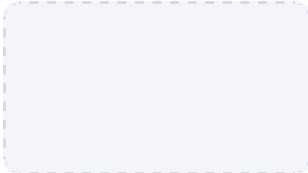
The first four only start working once someone is looking at your car. In a page of results a buyer sees one image per listing, and rules most of them out from that image alone.

SCROLLED PAST









OPENED

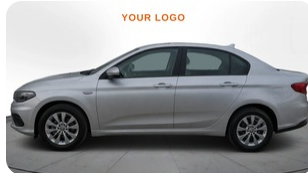
YOUR LOGO



YOUR LOGO



YOUR LOGO





90%

of customers say photos are an important part of the car shopping journey.

+40%

more likely to get a lead when a used listing shows real photos of the actual car.

+16%

more likely to submit an enquiry once a shopper interacts with the photos.

Same car. Same price. Same market.
Six things separate them. Here is the first.

Background

A buyer's eye has to find the car before it can judge it. Everything else in the frame slows that down.

Most listing photos are taken wherever the car happened to be parked, so half the picture belongs to somebody else: another car, a wall, a fence, a van. In a page of search results, that half is competing with yours.

AS YOU SHOT IT



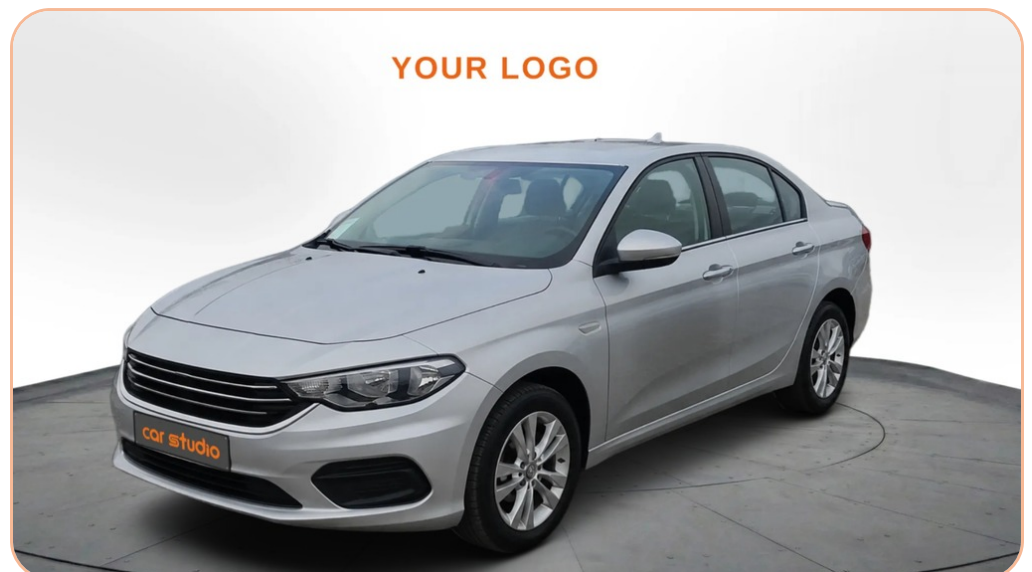
The eye finds the car

In a page of results your listing is one small square. If half of it is somebody else's stock, the buyer has moved on before working out which car is yours.

Weather stops mattering

Wet ground, flat light and long shadows make a well kept car look neglected. A fixed background takes all of it out of the picture.

ON A CLEAN BACKGROUND



The whole stock looks like one dealership

Scrolling your listings, a buyer sees a pattern instead of a series of unrelated snapshots taken on different days.

Shooting gets simpler

No moving the car to a good corner, no waiting for the weather. Photograph it where it stands. Across a hundred cars that is days.

**Both photos above are the same car, on the same day.
The one on the right is the one on the left, put through Car Studio AI.**

THAT'S ALL FIVE

Now open your own listing and look at it again.

Price, preparation, where you advertise and what the listing says are yours to fix today. The last one, what the listing shows, is the one we can take off your hands.

01 Upload what you already shot

02 Pick a background and a plate

03 Get every angle back, ready to publish

04 Photos, 360° tours and video

Try it free, 3 credits included →



car studio

Every photo in this guide was produced with Car Studio AI.
carstudio.ai